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“India is seen as expensive, lacks a strong AI play, and investors have found better opportunities elsewhere. If geopolitical tensions ease, selling may reduce but may not fully reverse”



FEROZE AZEEZ
JOINT CEO, ANAND
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“Domestic-oriented sectors appear better placed, particularly discretionary consumption such as passenger vehicles, jewellery retail and hospitals, where demand continues to hold up well”

GOLD & SILVER

With gold rising 75% in 2025 and silver over 150%, the outlook for precious metals appears more balanced. “While the long-term trend remains constructive, investors should be prepared for phases of consolidation, intermittent corrections, and higher volatility. The bias remains positive, but returns may be more tactical, requiring disciplined allocation and staggered buying,” says Navneet Damani, Senior Group Vice President-Head Research, MOFSL.

Gold and silver are being driven by a mix of global macro factors. Conflicts such as Israel-Hamas and Russia-Ukraine initially pushed demand, but in the absence of fresh escalation, there was some profit booking. At the same time, inflation concerns remain elevated. “Volatile crude oil prices are a key factor. Central banks have stayed cautious and delayed rate cuts. This has kept US bond yields and the dollar relatively strong, limiting any sharp upside in gold,” says Damani.

Liquidity has tightened globally. Changes in Japan’s policy and impact on yen carry trades have added to this pressure. However, the broader environment still supports gold. “Sticky inflation along with slowing growth raises stagflation risks. That is structurally positive for gold,” says Damani. “On the domestic front, gold is expected to test ₹1,85,000–1,90,000 on the upside. For silver, targets are placed near ₹3,30,000 on MCX. Overall, the bias remains constructive, but a staggered approach of investment is advised.”

Every market cycle may not be about chasing returns. There are periods in markets when it is more important to stay invested and survive before you thrive again. **BT**

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TRENDS SHAPING MFs

“Indian investors have become smart and are treating mutual funds as a disciplined savings avenue rather than a tactical investment product. This is clearly visible from the AMFI data, where consistent and rising SIP contributions even during volatile periods indicate a growing preference for long-term wealth creation over short-term market timing,” says Azeez of Anand Rathi Wealth.

As per AMFI data for March, SIP inflows touched record highs at ₹32,087 crore, marking the seventh consecutive month above the ₹29,000 crore level, while FY26 contributions stood at a strong ₹3.5 lakh crore. Equity inflows

remained robust at ₹40,450 crore, the highest since July 2025, suggesting that investors are using market corrections to increase allocations rather than exit.

For long-term investors, a structured asset allocation remains critical. “A balanced portfolio could include an 80:20 mix between equity and debt, with equity exposure diversified across large, mid, and small caps,” says Azeez. Equity diversification becomes key in volatile markets. “Equity investments should follow an ideal market cap mix of 50-55% in large-caps, 20-25% in mid-caps and the rest in small-caps. This will help investors ride all market cycles smoothly.”